PROSPER AWUNI

Senior SOC Detection Engineer | Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) Engineering and Threat Detection Specialist

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior SOC Detection Engineer with over five years of hands-on experience in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) engineering, detection rule development, threat hunting, and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) automation. I have expert-level experience with CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel, building and tuning detection logic using Kusto Query Language (KQL) aligned to MITRE ATT&CK tactics, techniques and procedures. I have a strong record of reducing false positives across enterprise environments, developing SOAR playbooks that accelerate analyst workflows, onboarding and normalising log sources, and translating threat intelligence into high-fidelity detection content. I also bring deep Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and Identity and Access Management (IAM) experience, making me well-suited to drive detection coverage improvements across SIEM, EDR/XDR and IAM platforms within a high-performance Security Operations Centre.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM Engineering and Detection:** CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL), detection rule creation and tuning, false positive reduction, use case development, log onboarding and normalisation, data pipeline management
- **SOAR and Automation:** SOAR playbook development, PowerShell scripting, API integration, workflow orchestration, alert enrichment and automated triage
- **Threat Detection and Hunting:** MITRE ATT&CK framework, threat hunting, Tactics Techniques and Procedures (TTP) analysis, threat intelligence integration, kill chain analysis, Indicators of Compromise (IoC) investigation
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR/XDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, CrowdStrike Falcon Insight EDR, CrowdStrike Falcon Discover, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender XDR, Tanium
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access policies, MFA enforcement, BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM)
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 incident response lifecycle, complex investigation support, root cause analysis, post-incident reporting
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus, remediation prioritisation and tracking
- **Cloud Security:** Microsoft Azure security controls, Microsoft 365 Defender, Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), cloud log integration and telemetry onboarding
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), MITRE ATT&CK, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Engineer and maintain SIEM detection logic in CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel using KQL, translating threat intelligence and MITRE ATT&CK use cases into high-fidelity detections, continuously tuning rules to reduce false positives across an 8,000-user environment.
- Develop and maintain SOAR playbooks using PowerShell scripting and API integrations, automating response workflows for phishing, account compromise and malware containment to reduce analyst manual effort and mean time to respond.
- Lead threat hunting activities on a weekly basis, forming hypotheses from threat intelligence and MITRE ATT&CK TTPs, querying CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Sentinel data lakes to identify attacker behaviour that bypassed automated detection.

- Onboard and normalise new log sources into Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike NG-SIEM, mapping data fields to the common information model and building parsers to ensure consistent telemetry for detection pipelines.
- Manage Endpoint Detection and Response operations using CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent and Insight EDR, configuring policies, managing exclusions and performing deep-dive forensic investigations of EDR-detected activity.
- Support complex incident investigations by correlating SIEM, EDR/XDR and IAM telemetry, producing timeline reconstructions and presenting findings with remediation recommendations to the Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) and senior stakeholders.
- Govern Identity and Access Management controls via Azure AD / Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access policies and BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management, ensuring IAM telemetry feeds detection pipelines for anomalous identity activity.
- Drive vulnerability management using Tenable.io and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation, feeding findings into detection use case backlog to improve coverage for known exploitable vulnerabilities.
- Contribute to continuous SOC improvement by documenting detection content, sharing threat hunting playbooks, and mentoring junior analysts on MITRE ATT&CK-aligned investigation techniques.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 - March 2025*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Delivered the full deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) and Microsoft 365 Defender across 8,000 users, onboarding device telemetry into Microsoft Sentinel and configuring initial detection rules and analytics.
- Performed daily SIEM alert triage from Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon, writing KQL queries to investigate suspicious activity, separating true positives from false positives and escalating high-confidence incidents to the senior analyst tier.
- Identified recurring false positive patterns and proposed and implemented detection rule tuning changes, reducing analyst noise across the busiest alert categories by iterative logic refinement.
- Administered Azure AD and Entra ID Identity Protection, configuring user and sign-in risk policies, and ensuring authentication anomalies generated actionable SIEM alerts via Sentinel log integration.
- Conducted regular vulnerability assessments using Nessus and AppCheck, producing risk-prioritised reports and tracking remediation through to closure with a structured ticketing and evidence workflow.
- Documented detection use cases, investigation runbooks and SOAR playbook logic, maintaining a knowledge base that improved analyst consistency and onboarding speed for new team members.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 - March 2022*

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

- Managed security, quality and infrastructure operations across a cloud-native SaaS and FinTech environment, including endpoint security, identity and access management, firewall policy and patch management.
- Deployed and managed Microsoft Intune MDM and MAM for corporate device enrolment and compliance, ensuring endpoint telemetry met the standards required for security monitoring.
- Implemented identity and access controls aligned to ISO 27001, including role-based access reviews, privileged account management and multi-factor authentication enforcement.
- Conducted regular vulnerability scans, tracked remediation against agreed Service Level Agreement (SLA) windows, and supported the security incident response process with log collection and root cause investigation.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Reduced false positive volume by 40% at UAL through systematic CrowdStrike NG-SIEM and Sentinel detection rule tuning, freeing analyst capacity equivalent to approximately one full-time analyst day per week.
- Developed a threat hunting programme aligned to MITRE ATT&CK that identified three previously undetected lateral movement attempts within the first year, enabling containment before data exfiltration occurred.
- Built and automated 12 SOAR playbooks covering the most common alert categories, reducing mean time to respond for those categories by over 35% and eliminating repetitive manual steps from the analyst workflow.
- Led the onboarding of seven new log sources into Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike NG-SIEM, normalising data fields and creating 14 new detection rules that expanded coverage across previously unmonitored attack surfaces.
- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Identity and M365 Defender across 8,000 users with zero production outages, establishing a comprehensive EDR/XDR telemetry baseline that fed SIEM detection pipelines from day one.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)